

qBittorrent Search Plugin Troubleshooting Guide

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This guide covers common issues with search plugins and their solutions.

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Known Issues

Issue 1: Downloads Don't Start from Search (WebUI Only)

Symptom: You search for torrents using RuTracker or other private trackers, find results, click download, but the torrent never appears in the download list.

Root Cause: qBittorrent WebUI has a fundamental limitation where it does NOT use `nova2dl.py` for downloading torrents from search results. Instead, it tries to download the torrent URL directly, which fails for private trackers that require authentication.

Affected Plugins: - RuTracker (requires login) - Kinozal (requires login) - NNMCclub (requires login) - Rutor (works with magnet links)

Solutions:

Option A: Use qBittorrent Desktop Application (Recommended)

The desktop app properly uses `nova2dl.py` which handles authentication:

```
# Install plugins for desktop app
./install-plugin.sh --local rutracker
```

Option B: Use Magnet Links Instead

Configure Rutor plugin to return magnet links instead of .torrent files:

```
# Edit .env file
RUTOR_USE_MAGNET=true
```

Option C: Manual Download

1. Search for torrents in WebUI

2. Note the torrent name/size
3. Go to the tracker website directly
4. Download the .torrent file manually
5. Add it to qBittorrent via "Upload local torrent" button

Option D: Use Alternative Trackers

Rutor works best with WebUI because it provides magnet links that don't require authentication.

Issue 2: Only RuTracker Plugin Visible

Symptom: In the Search > Search Plugins section, only RuTracker appears even though all 4 plugins should be installed.

Root Causes: 1. Plugins not properly copied to the container 2. File permissions incorrect 3. Container not restarted after plugin installation 4. Plugin syntax errors

Solutions:

Step 1: Verify Plugin Installation

```
./install-plugin.sh --verify
```

This will check: - All plugin files exist - Files have correct permissions - Python syntax is valid

Step 2: Reinstall All Plugins

```
# Reinstall all plugins
./install-plugin.sh --all

# Verify installation
./install-plugin.sh --verify
```

Step 3: Check Container Plugins

```
# For Podman
podman exec qbittorrent ls -la /config/qBittorrent/nova3/engines/

# For Docker
docker exec qbittorrent ls -la /config/qBittorrent/nova3/engines/
```

You should see all 4 plugin files: - rutracker.py - rutor.py - kinozal.py - nmclub.py

Step 4: Restart Container

```
# For Podman
podman restart qbittorrent

# For Docker
docker restart qbittorrent
```

Step 5: Refresh WebUI

After restarting, hard-refresh the WebUI page (Ctrl+Shift+R or Cmd+Shift+R).

Quick Fixes

Fix All Issues at Once

```
# 1. Stop container
./stop.sh

# 2. Reinstall all plugins
./install-plugin.sh --all

# 3. Verify installation
./install-plugin.sh --verify

# 4. Start container
./start.sh

# 5. Wait for container to be ready, then refresh WebUI
sleep 5
```

Run All Tests

```
# Test plugin installation and structure
python3 -m pytest tests/unit/ --import-mode=importlib

# Test download functionality
python3 tests/test_download_comprehensive.py
```

WebUI vs Desktop App

WebUI Limitations

The qBittorrent WebUI has a fundamental limitation with search plugin downloads:

WebUI Search Flow:

1. User searches â†’ WebUI calls plugin's search() method â€œ Works
2. User clicks download â†’ WebUI sends URL to /api/v2/torrents/add â€œ Pr
3. Backend tries to download URL directly â€œ No authentication!
4. Download fails for private trackers â€œ

Desktop App Flow:

1. User searches â†’ App calls plugin's search() method â€œ Works
2. User clicks download â†’ App calls nova2dl.py â€œ Correct!
3. nova2dl.py uses plugin's download_torrent() method â€œ Authenticated!
4. Download succeeds â€œ

Recommendations

Use Case	Recommended Approach
Private trackers (RuTracker, Kinozal, NNMClub)	Use Desktop App or manual download
Public trackers with magnets (Rutor)	Works with both WebUI and Desktop
Automation/Remote access	Use magnet links where possible

Plugin Installation

Install All Plugins

```
./install-plugin.sh --all
```

Install Specific Plugin

```
./install-plugin.sh rutracker
```

Install Locally (Desktop App)

```
./install-plugin.sh --local rutracker
```

Verify Installation

```
./install-plugin.sh --verify
```

Test Plugins

```
./install-plugin.sh --test
```

Download Issues

Testing Download Functionality

Test via nova2dl.py (Command Line)

```
# Test RuTracker download (works with authentication)
podman exec -u abc qbittorrent \
  python3 /config/qBittorrent/nova3/nova2dl.py \
  rutracker 'https://rutracker.org/forum/dl.php?t=6782121'
```

```
# Expected output:
```

```
# /tmp/rutracker_xxx.torrent https://rutracker.org/forum/dl.php?t=6782121
```

Test Plugin Directly

```
# Test RuTracker plugin
python3 plugins/rutracker.py
```

Common Download Errors

â€œUnable to connect using given credentialsâ€

- Check your RuTracker username/password in `.env` file
- Verify credentials work on `rutracker.org` website
- Check if RuTracker is accessible (try different mirrors)

â€œNo data received from URLâ€

- The torrent might have been removed
- Try a different torrent
- Check if you have permission to access the torrent

â€œReceived HTML page instead of torrent fileâ€

- Authentication failed
- Your session might have expired
- Try restarting the container

Debugging Steps

Enable Debug Logging

For RuTracker Plugin

Edit `plugins/rutracker.py` and change:

```
logging.basicConfig(level=logging.WARNING)
```

to:

```
logging.basicConfig(level=logging.DEBUG)
```

For Container

```
# View container logs
podman logs -f qbittorrent
```

```
# Or
docker logs -f qbittorrent
```

Check Plugin Status via API

```
# Get list of installed plugins
curl -X POST \
  http://localhost:7186/api/v2/auth/login \
  -d "username=admin&password=admin"

curl -X GET \
```

```
http://localhost:7186/api/v2/search/plugins \
-b "SID=your_session_id"
```

Manual Plugin Testing

```
# Test plugin directly
import sys
sys.path.insert(0, 'plugins')
from rutracker import RuTracker

# Create instance
engine = RuTracker()

# Test search
engine.search("ubuntu")
print(f"Found {len(engine.results)} results")

# Test download (if results found)
if engine.results:
    first = list(engine.results.values())[0]
    engine.download_torrent(first['link'])
```

Check File Permissions

```
# Check plugin files in container
podman exec qbittorrent ls -la /config/qBittorrent/nova3/engines/

# Should show:
# -rw-r--r-- 1 abc abc rutracker.py
# -rw-r--r-- 1 abc abc rutor.py
# -rw-r--r-- 1 abc abc kinozal.py
# -rw-r--r-- 1 abc abc nnmclub.py
```

Reset Everything

If nothing else works, reset the entire setup:

```
# 1. Stop and remove container
./stop.sh -r

# 2. Remove config (WARNING: This removes all settings!)
rm -rf config/qBittorrent

# 3. Reinstall plugins
./install-plugin.sh --all

# 4. Start fresh
./start.sh
```

FAQ

Q: Why do magnet links work but .torrent files donâ€™t?

A: Magnet links donâ€™t require authentication to the tracker. Theyâ€™re just a URL that qBittorrent can handle directly. .torrent files from private trackers require you to be logged in to download them.

Q: Can I fix the WebUI to use nova2dl.py?

A: This would require modifying qBittorrentâ€™s core code. The WebUI is designed to work with magnet links and public trackers. For private trackers, use the desktop app.

Q: Do I need credentials for all plugins?

A: - RuTracker: Yes, requires username/password - **Rutor:** No, works without authentication - **Kinozal:** Yes, requires username/password - **NNMClub:** Yes, requires cookies

Q: How do I get NNMClub cookies?

A: 1. Login to nnmclub.to in your browser 2. Open browser developer tools (F12) 3. Go to Application/Storage > Cookies 4. Copy the cookie string 5. Add to .env:
NNMCLUB_COOKIES="name1=value1; name2=value2"

Q: Can I use a proxy?

A: Yes, some plugins support proxies:

```
# For Rutor
RUTOR_PROXY_ENABLED=true
RUTOR_PROXY_HTTP=http://proxy:8080
RUTOR_PROXY_HTTPS=https://proxy:8080
```

Getting Help

If youâ€™re still having issues:

1. Run the test suite: `python3 -m pytest tests/unit/ --import-mode=importlib`
2. Check container logs: `podman logs qbittorrent`
3. Enable debug logging in plugins
4. Check qBittorrentâ€™s official documentation: <https://wiki.qbittorrent.org/>

Summary

Issue	Quick Fix
Downloads donâ€™t start	Use desktop app or magnet links
Only RuTracker visible	Run <code>./install-plugin.sh --all</code> and restart container
Plugin errors	Run <code>./install-plugin.sh --verify</code>

Issue

Authentication failed

Slow downloads

Quick Fix

Check credentials in `.env` file

Try different mirrors or use proxy

Remember: The fundamental limitation is that WebUI cannot download from private trackers directly. Use the desktop app or magnet links as workarounds.